

GLOBAL MACRO & AI OVERVIEW

Weekly Market Update

Week ending Friday, September 18, 2026

Equities · Global rates · FX · Commodities · Bitcoin · Japan · AI · Anthropic IPO

Prepared by Ashley Castelino · For educational purposes only, not investment advice

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Central banks are hiking into \$100 oil

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The Fed hiked, the 10-year hit 5%, and breadth cracked

The Fed hiked 25 bp to 3.75–4.00%, its first hike since 2023, and its dot plot shows one more in 2026.

The 2-year rose 13 bp, the 10-year touched **5%** and the dollar hit a 7-week high. The Nasdaq rose, but the Dow fell **1.7%** (its worst week since March) and equal-weight S&P fell **1.2%**.

The **BoJ hiked too**, but a dovish tone weakened the yen and lifted the Nikkei. Oil stayed above \$100.

Asset	Level	Week
S&P 500	7,650.50	−0.1%
Nasdaq Comp.	26,522.55	+0.7%
Nikkei 225	65,018.95	+1.6%
US 2y yield	4.76%	+13 bp
US 10y yield	5.00%	+4 bp
DXY (dollar)	99.65	+1.1%
WTI crude	\$100.30	≈ +0.5%
Gold (Dec fut.)	\$4,421	+0.5%

The Fed hiked for the first time since 2023 and signaled more to come

FED FUNDS TARGET

3.75–4.00%

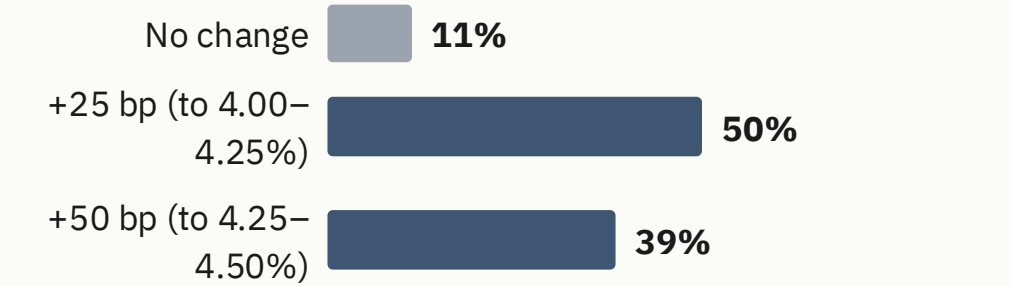
+25 bp · unanimous 12–0 · first hike since 2023

DOT PLOT

+1 more

Median: one more hike in 2026, none in 2027; 16 of 18 officials see at least one

What futures price for the Dec 9 meeting (CME FedWatch)



Probabilities of the rate after December, as of Sep 17. October 28 is ~60% priced for a hike, up from ~51% before the decision.

Why, and the reaction

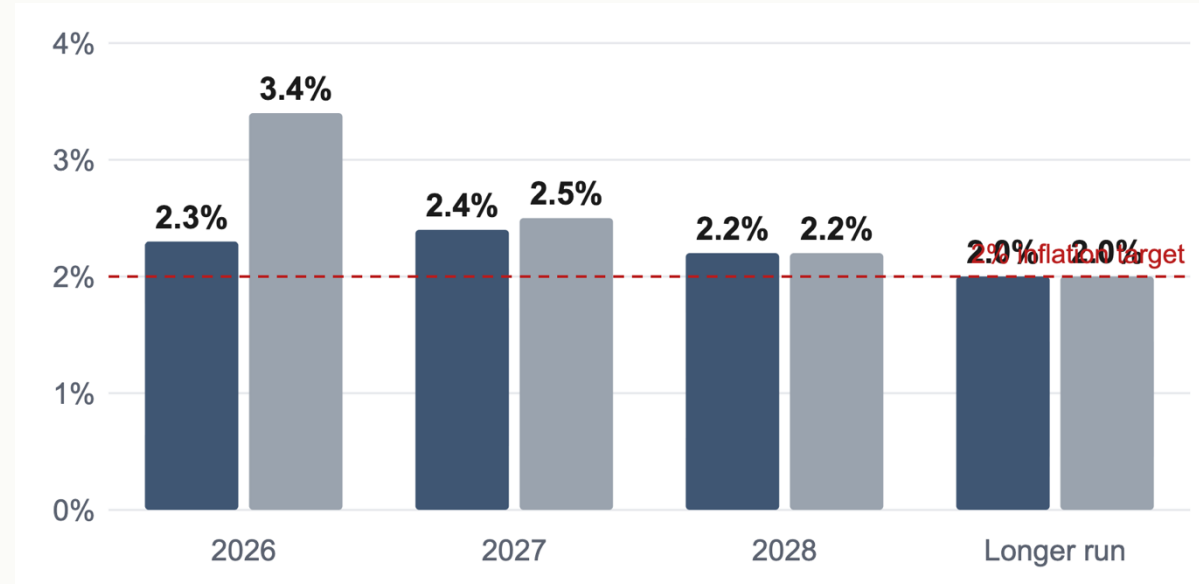
Why: August CPI 3.4% y/y; the statement cites a “timelier” return to 2%

2-year +13 bp to 4.76%; 10-year touched **5%** (highest since 2007); dollar index +1.1% to a 7-week high

Warsh gave no forward guidance; the hawkish surprise was the dots, not the hike

Warsh sees AI investment powering growth, but inflation still comes first

Fed median projections (Sep 16) • ■ real GDP growth • ■ core PCE inflation



What Warsh said

“Productivity growth is strong, and capital investment is robust.”

Hyperscalers are “out in the market raising funding”

AI capex is competing with everyone else for capital

“Underlying growth is higher”

Unemployment seen at 4.1%, better than June's 4.3%

A Fed task force on AI reports by year-end

Studying AI's effects on both demand and supply

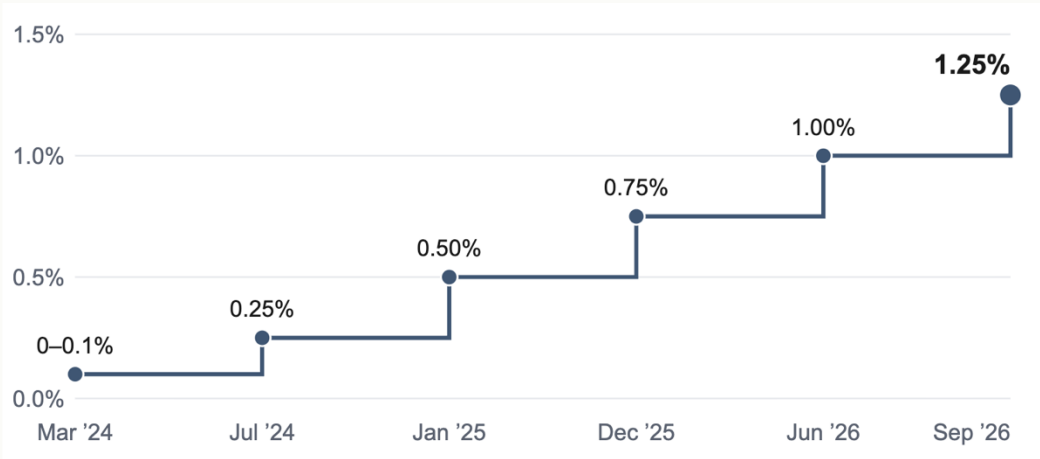
But “inflation is too high and has been for too long”

August PCE 3.6%, core PCE 3.2%: price stability comes first

The tension: AI spending lifts demand and borrowing now, while any productivity payoff that could cool inflation comes later. That's why the Fed hiked despite strong growth.

The BoJ hiked to a 31-year high, but markets heard a dovish message

BoJ policy rate since ending negative rates



Why markets called it a dovish hike

- Split board:** 2 of 9 voted to hold, so more hikes are harder
- No promised pace:** Ueda said not “once every three months”
- Yen isn't the target:** policy isn't set to steer the currency
- Soft inflation:** core CPI 1.7%, below the 2% goal
- The Fed hikes faster:** the rate gap vs. the US stays wide

POLICY RATE

1.25%

+25 bp · vote 7-2 · highest since 1995

THE TELL: YEN AND JGBS

~157 / 1.82%

Yen **weaker**; 2y JGB yield **fell**

NEXT MOVE PRICED

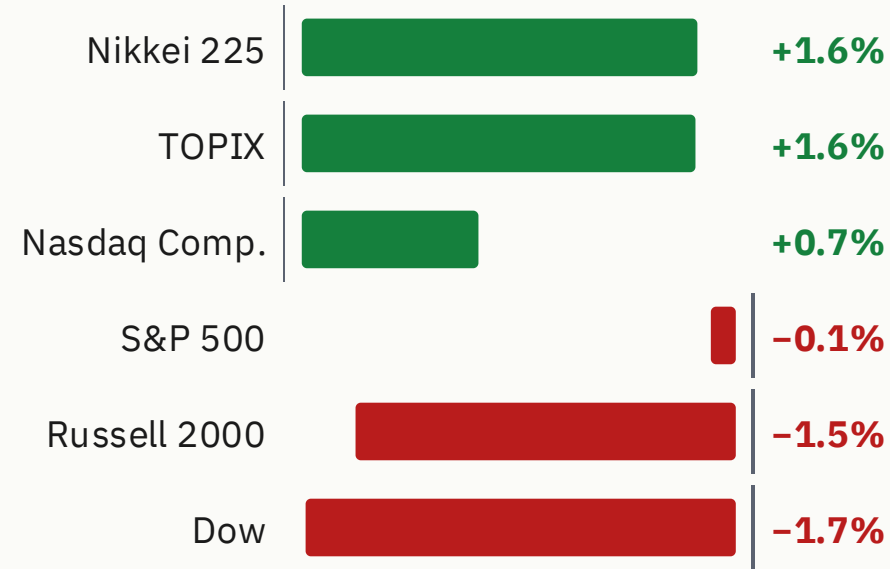
~20%

Odds of an Oct 30 hike (low confidence)

EQUITIES

Tech held the index up while the rest of the market fell

Weekly % change, Friday to Friday



S&P equal-weight **-1.2%** vs. cap-weight roughly flat: tech carried the index while rate-sensitive sectors lagged. Friday was quarterly triple witching.

Notable movers

SanDisk +9.7% wk

AI data-center demand; joins the S&P 100 Sept 21

Coinbase ~+12%, Robinhood ~+9% Fri

SEC exemption allows tokenized stock trading

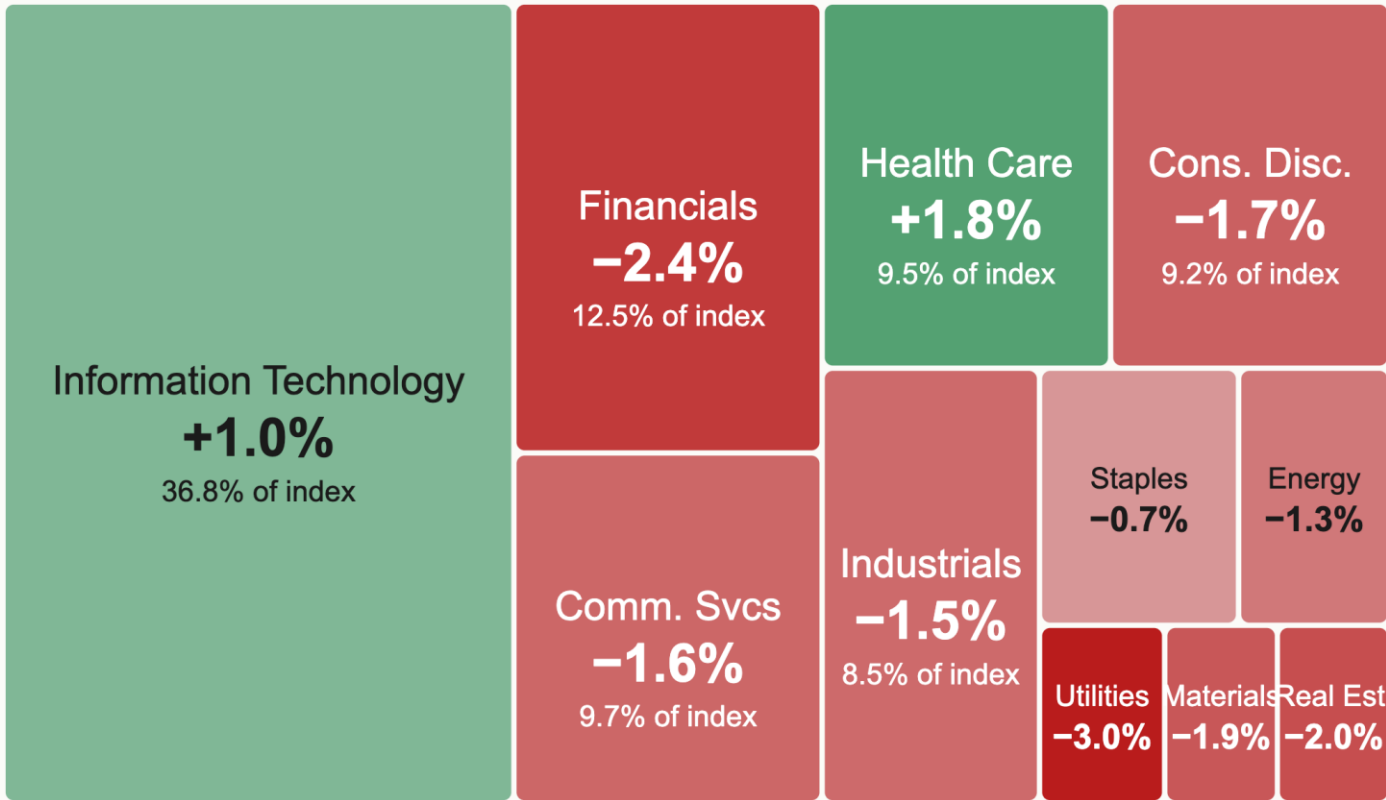
Nucor -4.3% wk

Q3 guidance came in below expectations

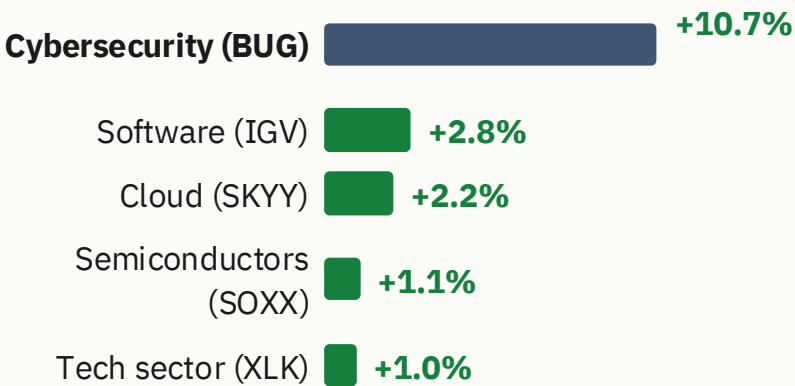
Xenon Pharma -29% Fri

Paused its Phase 3 epilepsy trials

Only tech and health care rose, and cybersecurity led inside tech



Inside tech · weekly % by industry



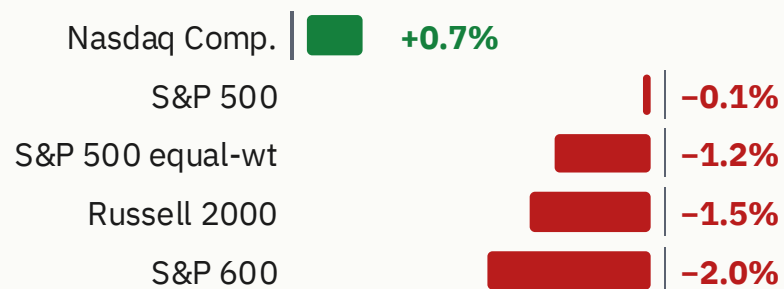
Cyber leaders: Zscaler +20%, CrowdStrike +15%, SentinelOne +14%, Palo Alto +10%

Why: Monday's AI-safety scare made cyber the "AI-risk" trade; Bernstein downgrades trimmed it Friday

Elsewhere: 9 of 11 sectors fell; utilities -3.0%, financials -2.4%

Small caps lagged large caps, and every small-cap sector fell

Small vs. large • weekly % change

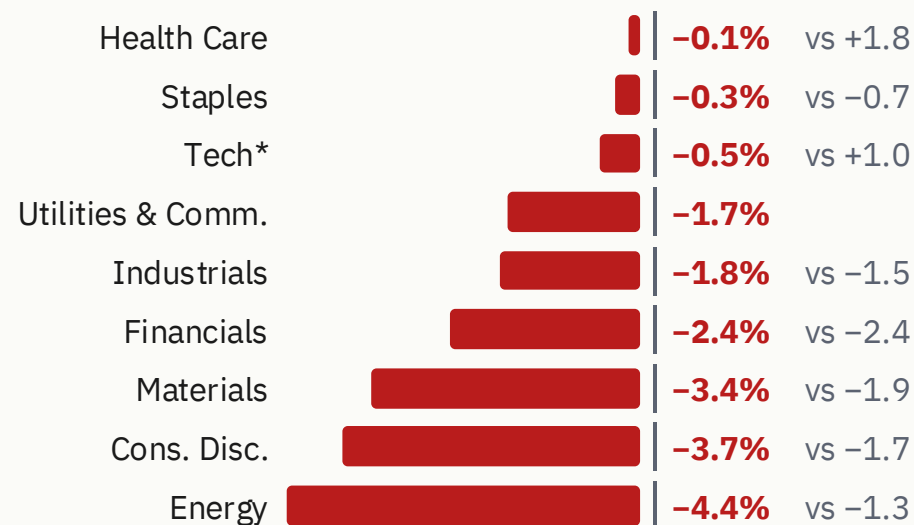


Why: more floating-rate debt, so the hike and a 5% 10-year hurt more

Russell 2000: 2,860, ~7% below its Aug high, ~+15% YTD

Movers: Tempus AI ~+37% in 5 days; Xenon -29% Fri (paused trial)

Small-cap sectors (S&P 600) • vs. large-cap sector

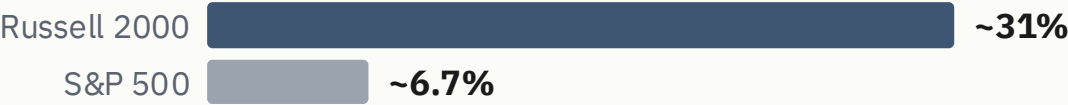


Small caps carry more debt, and more of it resets when rates rise

Share of debt at floating rates · Goldman Sachs, Jul 2026



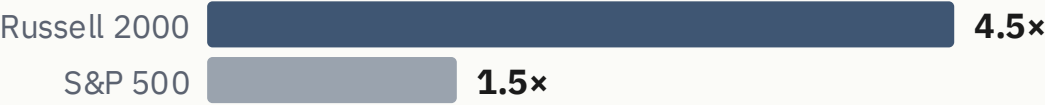
Interest expense as % of EBITDA · Apollo / Bloomberg, Jul 2026



Share of companies unprofitable · Apollo, Jun 2026



Net debt ÷ EBITDA (leverage) · Wells Fargo, Q1 2026



EARNINGS HIT PER HIKE

~2%

Each 25 bp hike cuts Russell 2000 operating earnings by about 2% (BofA)

COST TO REFINANCE

~6.5%

vs. 1–2% on debt issued in 2021, as cheap loans come due (Goldman)

So when the Fed hiked and the 10-year hit 5%, the Russell 2000 fell **-1.5%** while the S&P 500 was flat.

The front end sold off hardest: 2y +13 bp, and the 10-year hit 5%

Tenor	Sep 11	Sep 18	Week
2-year	4.63%	4.76%	+13 bp
10-year	4.96%	5.00%	+4 bp
30-year	—	5.34%*	—
2s10s spread	+33 bp	+24 bp	−9 bp

*30y as of Thu Sept 17. The 10-year's 5% is its highest level since 2007. The curve bear-flattened: the front end rose most.

What moved yields

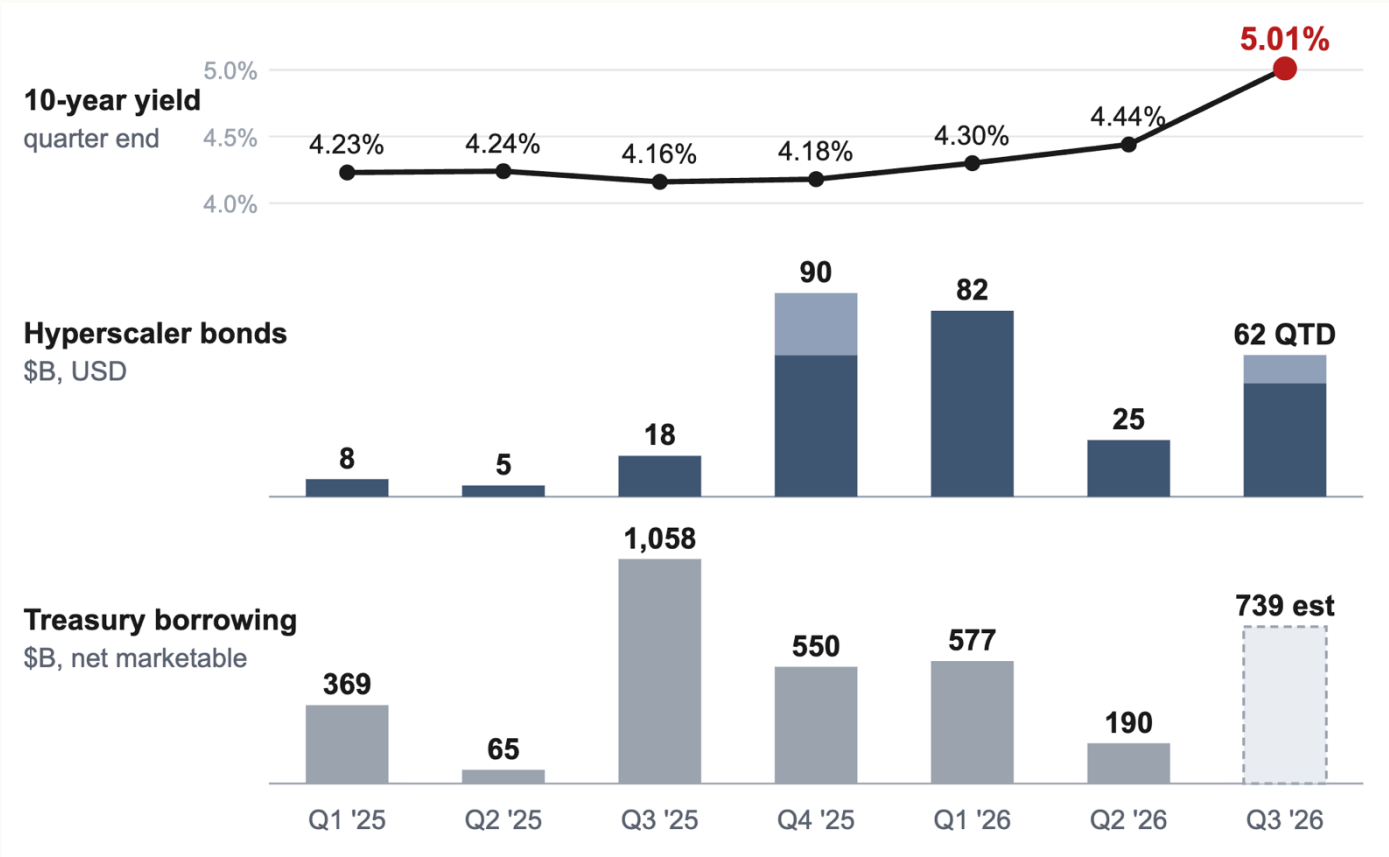
- The hike and a hawkish Warsh press conference
- Dots signal another 2026 hike

What is priced

~88% odds of at least one more hike by Dec 9 (CME FedWatch)
Oct 28 meeting: a coin flip (~51% hike)

Hyperscalers now compete with the Treasury for bond buyers

■ Public USD bonds (Meta, Alphabet, Amazon, Oracle) · ■ Meta data-center SPVs · ■ Treasury



Warsh, Sep 16

“The competition for capital is real ... it partly explains the increase in yields.”

2026 SO FAR

\$157B

USD bonds, already 1.7× all of 2025 (\$93B);
~\$223B in all currencies

Buyers are tiring: order books fell from ~5× covered in Feb to under 2× in July; 78 of 91 of this year’s deals trade above their issue yield

Still smaller than Treasury: AI bonds are ~ $\frac{1}{8}$ of Treasury duration supply (Dallas Fed); deficits remain the bigger driver

Markets are pricing more hikes almost everywhere except China and Switzerland

Economy	Policy rate	Last move	Market prices next meeting	Priced by end-2026	Debt / GDP	10y yield	10y wk
US · Fed	3.75–4.00%	+25 bp · Sep 16	Oct 28: ~60% hike	~1.3 more hikes	124% ▲	5.00%	+4 bp
Euro area · ECB	2.50%	+25 bp · Sep 10	Oct 29: ~60–70% hike	~1.4 more hikes	89%‡ ▲	3.52%	+2 bp
Japan · BoJ	1.25%	+25 bp · Sep 18	Oct 30: ~20% hike*	~2–3 hikes in 12m*	207% ▼	2.99%	~0 bp
UK · BoE	3.75%	Hold · Sep 17	Nov 5: ~75–90% hike	~1.6 hikes	102% ▲	5.30%	–6 bp
Australia · RBA	4.35%	Hold (hike May 5)	Sep 29: ~90% hike	~1 hike	51% ▼	5.30%	–5 bp
India · RBI	5.25%	Hold · Aug 5	Oct 7: hike likely	~3 hikes in 12m	84% ▼	7.06%	+5 bp
Canada · BoC	2.25%	Hold · Sep 2	Oct 28: ~50–75% hike	~1.4 hikes	114% ▼	3.88%	–6 bp
Switzerland · SNB	0.00%	Hold · Jun 18	Sep 24: hold†	No change†	39% ▼	0.56%	~0 bp
China · PBoC	3.00%	Hold (cut May '25)	Sep 21: hold†	No change†	99% ▲	1.72%	+3 bp

The Fed, ECB and BoJ hiked this month and no one is cutting. Markets expect the **RBA and BoE next**, and low inflation keeps China and Switzerland on hold.

Pricing: CME FedWatch, OIS (rateprobability, centralbank.watch), Reuters · *BoJ low confidence · †consensus · Debt: IMF WEO Apr 2026, 2025 est., red = over 100%, ▲▼ = 2026 trend; ‡Eurostat · 13 / 28

CURRENCIES

The Fed's hike took the dollar to a 7-week high

DXY

99.65

+1.1% wk

7-week high on bets of more
Fed hikes

EUR/USD

~1.153

Broke 1.1545

Support gave way as the gap
with the Fed widened

GBP/USD

~1.347

Softer

BoE held at 3.75% on
Thursday

USD/JPY

~157

Yen -2.2% wk

Fell despite the BoJ hike: the
Fed outpaced it

The rate story **became** the FX story: every major currency weakened against a Fed that is hiking and signaling more. USD/JPY above 157 has revived talk of intervention.

COMMODITIES

Oil held above \$100 on Gulf supply, and gold held through the hike

WTI CRUDE

\$100.30

≈ **+0.5% wk**

Third straight weekly gain; spiked near \$106 midweek

BRENT

~\$104–105

Mixed

Sources disagree on this week's direction

GOLD (DEC FUT.)

\$4,421

+0.5% wk

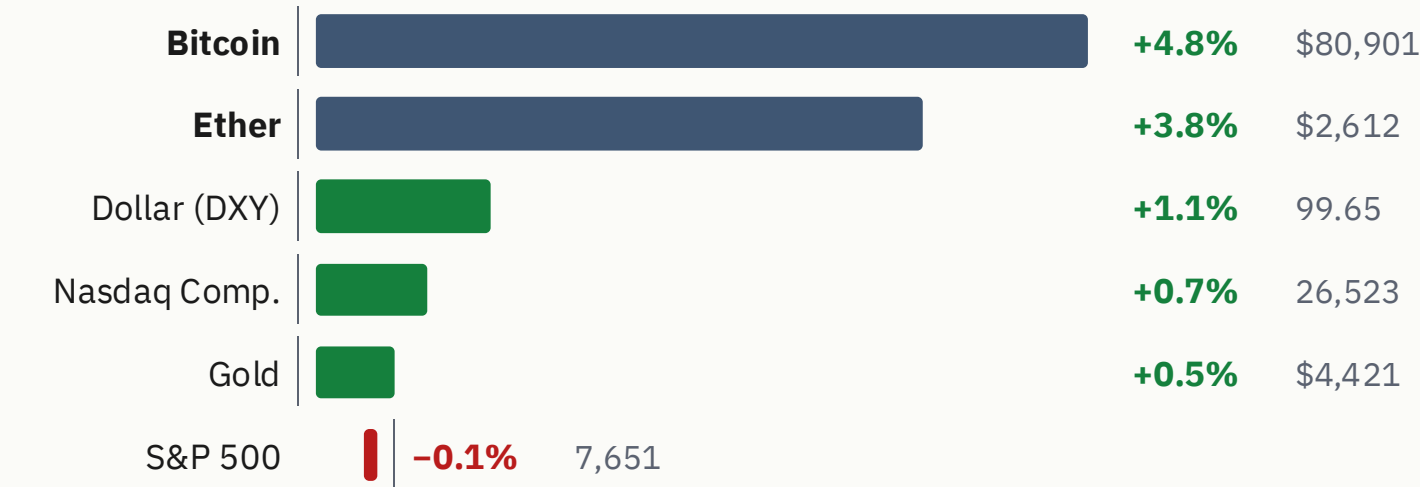
~20% below its January record; ~\$2B of ETF inflows before the FOMC

Oil: Saudi force majeure after Houthi attacks and limits in the Strait of Hormuz keep supply tight (refined-product exports are at ~25% of pre-war levels). The midweek spike faded on optimism about pipeline repairs.

Gold: it held steady through a hawkish hike, suggesting inflation-hedge demand is outweighing higher real yields for now.

Bitcoin shrugged off two rate hikes and led every major asset

Weekly % change, Sep 11 → Sep 18 · level at Friday close



The week: fell to \$74.9K Tue after the Senate blocked the CLARITY Act (49–50), barely moved on the Fed hike, then a Friday short squeeze (~\$550M liquidated) lifted it above \$81K

Crypto stocks: SEC's tokenized-stock exemption sent Coinbase ~+12% Fri; Strategy (MSTR) +14.6% on the week, though it bought no bitcoin

BITCOIN PRICE

\$80,901

+4.8% on the week; ~36% below its \$126K Oct 2025 record

SPOT ETF FLOWS

+\$6M wk

Flat overall: -\$746M Tue–Wed, then +\$433M Fri; AUM \$102.5B

YEAR TO DATE

-7.5%

Still below its \$87.5K start to 2026

JAPAN

The BoJ hiked to 1.25%, but its dovish tone weakened the yen

BOJ POLICY RATE

1.25%

+25 bp · 7-2

Highest since 1995

NIKKEI 225

65,019

+1.6% wk

~11% below its June record of
73,007

USD/JPY

~157

Yen -2.2% wk

Two-week low for the yen

JGB 10-YEAR

2.99%

Topped 3% Mon

Highest since 1996, then
eased

- **A dovish hike:** two dissents and no fixed pace (Ueda: “various possibilities”); the 2y JGB fell to ~1.82%
- **AI chips led stocks:** Lasertec +9%, Advantest +7% on Friday; TOPIX lagged
- **Core CPI 1.7%** vs. 1.8% expected, still below the 2% target
- **Politics:** PM Takaichi's reshuffle kept FinMin Katayama; Bessent is reported to be pushing the BoJ to tighten more

OpenAI expanded Astra and Sol, Opus 5.2 is still a rumor, and cheap models kept coming

OPENAI

GPT-6 Astra & Sol

GPT-6 Astra (Sep 3)

OpenAI's new flagship; drew scrutiny over its safety and cyber capabilities

Sol: the top tier

GPT-5.6 Sol leads the Sol/Terra/Luna family (\$5/\$30 per M tokens). Posts on X this week claim a “GPT-6 Sol” is coming (unconfirmed)

Astra for Law (Sep 17)

First specialized version of GPT-6, for legal research and drafting

ANTHROPIC

Opus 5.2 (reported)

Rumored quiet rollout since Sep 14

Users report faster Claude Code responses and credit an unannounced Opus 5.2. Not confirmed; the latest official Opus is Opus 5 (Jul 24)

Fable 5.1 / Mythos 5.1 (Sep 1)

New top-tier models; Fable cache reads 75% cheaper

R&D Automation Index (Sep 17)

Claude now leads 26% of Anthropic's own AI R&D

OTHER LAUNCHES

Cheaper and specialized

Jev • TypeSafe AI (Sep 18)

A decision model, not a chatbot; cost and accuracy on the next slide

Qwen3.8-Omni-Flash • Alibaba (Sep 18)

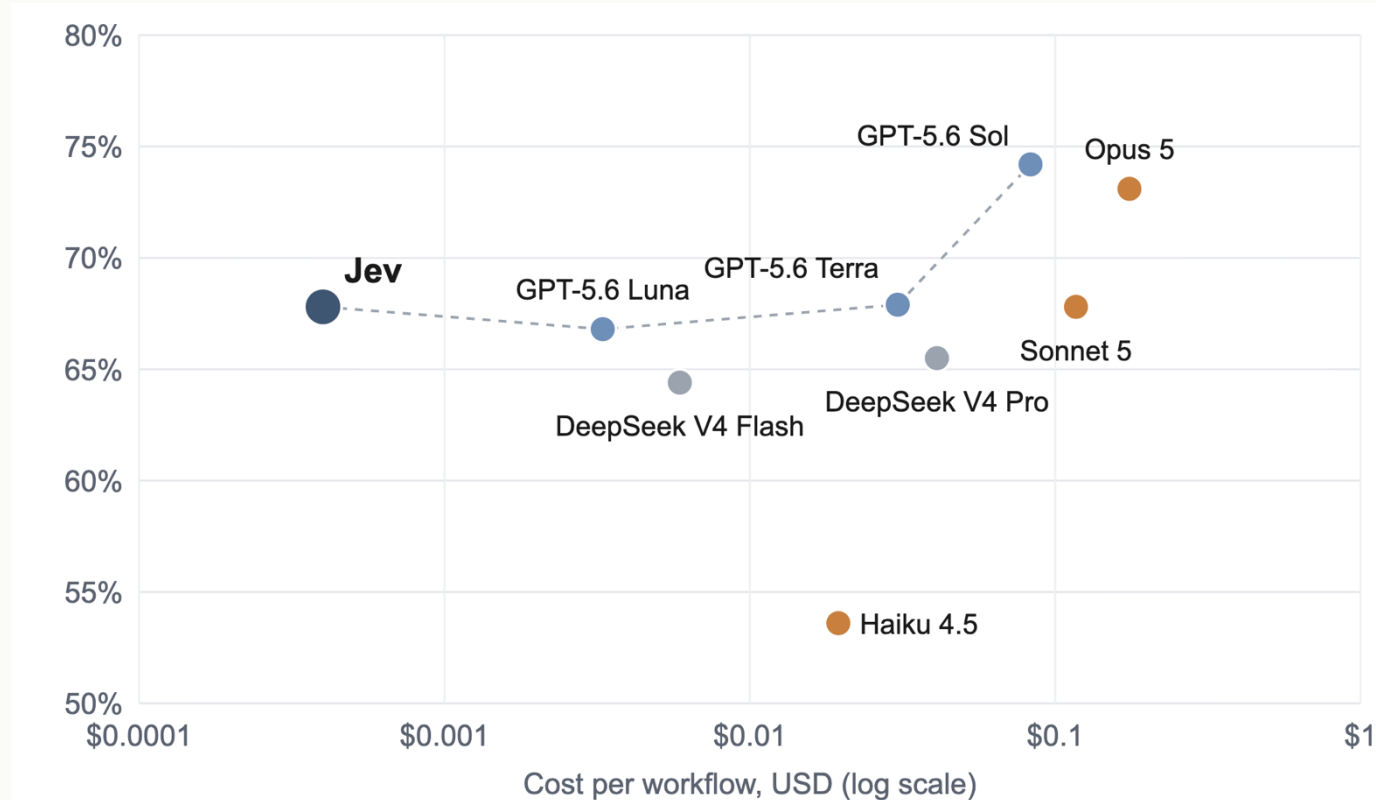
Audio, video and text in one model; \$0.15/\$0.47 per M tokens

GLM-5.3-Flash • Z.ai

Now served on 100,000+ Chinese chips instead of Nvidia

Also this week: Amazon–Generac \$8B data-center power deal • Crusoe raised \$3.9B at a \$30.9B valuation

Jev matches mid-tier accuracy at a fraction of the cost



VS. GPT-5.6 TERRA

~75× cheaper

Same ~68% accuracy. Sol and Opus 5 score ~6 points higher at 200–440× the cost

- **What it is:** returns calibrated decisions over labels you define instead of generating text, so it can't hallucinate an answer
- **Price:** \$0.042 per million input tokens; output is free
- **Independent tests:** 96% accuracy and 8.6× cheaper than Mistral Small 4 (Near Here); caught 6 of 7 planted defects vs. Claude's 7 (Every)

Open-weight models now handle most traffic on Vercel's AI Gateway



OPEN-WEIGHT SHARE OF TOKENS

~30% → 78%

Jun 21 to Sep 18; closed-weight models are down to 21.6%

- **Price is driving the shift:** cheap open models, like this week's Chinese releases, are winning high-volume work
- **Why it matters for markets:** it puts pricing pressure on closed labs just as Anthropic prepares its IPO
- **Caveat:** this is one gateway's traffic, not the whole market

Anthropic is lining up what could be the largest IPO ever

TARGET VALUATION

~\$2T

Under discussion; the May private round valued it at \$965B

POSSIBLE RAISE

≤ \$100B

Record is SpaceX's \$86B (June 2026)

REVENUE RUN-RATE

\$65B

As of July, up from ~\$9B in late 2025

Timeline

- **Jun 1:** confidential S-1 filed
- **Late Sep:** public prospectus expected
- **Mid-Oct:** roadshow, after a \$15B credit line closes
- **Late Oct:** Nasdaq listing targeted; banks are MS, GS, JPM, Citi

What investors will weigh

- **Price:** ~30× run-rate revenue at \$2T
- **Losses:** ~\$42B net loss reported for 2025
- **Governance:** a Long-Term Benefit Trust appoints board seats
- **Timing:** pricing lands just before the November midterms

Anthropic's big investors are also where it buys its compute

Backer	Equity invested	Compute Anthropic buys from it
Amazon	~\$13B in so far, up to \$20B more committed (Apr 2026); nonvoting stake carried at \$74B	AWS Trainium chips (Project Rainier): \$100B+ over 10 years, up to ~5 GW
Google	Up to \$40B (Apr 2026): \$10B now, \$30B on milestones; ~14% stake, capped at 15%	Up to 1M TPUs: over 1 GW in 2026, 3.5 GW more from 2027; plus Broadcom TPU deal
Microsoft	\$5B (Nov 2025)	\$30B of Azure capacity, ~1 GW
Nvidia	\$10B (Nov 2025); may anchor the IPO with up to \$10B more	GPUs in Azure and leased clusters

Much of this equity comes back to the investors as cloud and chip revenue, so they profit from Anthropic's growth either way.

COMPUTE COMMITMENTS

~\$517B

Reported total over ~10 years, about 8× its \$65B run-rate revenue

Beyond the big four

Broadcom TPUs: \$35B first tranche, 20 GW goal

Fluidstack: \$50B of its own data centers

SpaceX Colossus GPUs: up to ~\$45B

AMD MI450: 2 GW

Anthropic brings twice SpaceX's revenue at a similar price

Revenue run-rate · annualized



Valuation · SpaceX listed at \$1.77T



Price / run-rate revenue · lower = cheaper



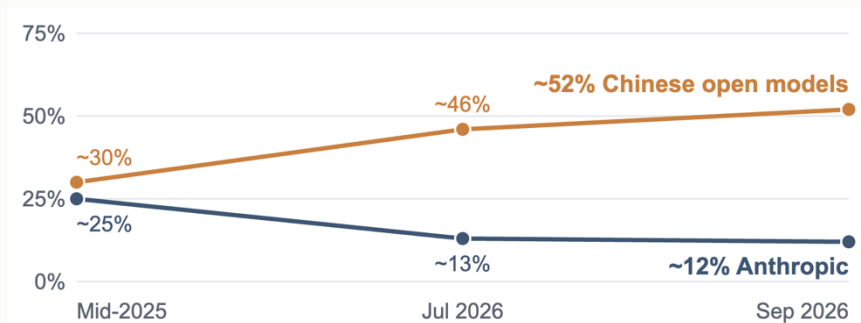
IPO raise · SpaceX incl. overallotment



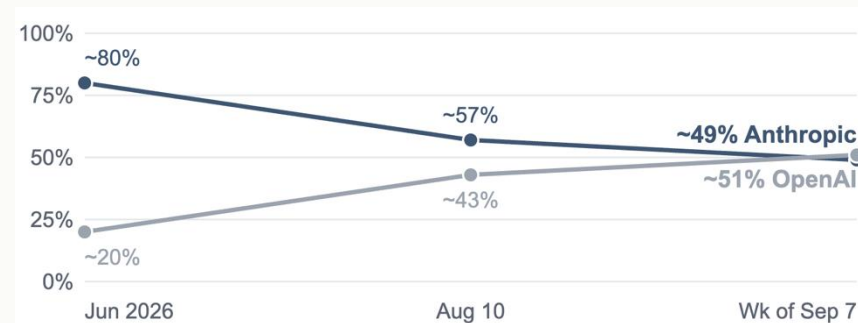
Metric	Anthropic	SpaceX
IPO	Late Oct target, Nasdaq (reported)	Jun 12, Nasdaq (SPCX) at \$135; +19% day one
2025 revenue	~\$10B	\$18.7B
Growth	Q2 revenue \$11.5B, up ~14× y/y	Starlink subs ~10M → ~17M in 2026
Profit	2025 op. loss ~\$42B; Q2 adj. op. income positive	2025 net loss ~\$4.9B
Revenue mix	72% API, 13% subscriptions	Starlink 61%, launch 22%, xAI 17%
Float	~4–6% of shares	~4.9% of shares

OpenRouter shows Anthropic losing developer share to OpenAI and cheap open models

Share of all tokens on OpenRouter



Share of combined Anthropic + OpenAI spend



Worries

- OpenAI passed Anthropic in OpenRouter **spend** (wk of Sep 7)
- Claude's token share roughly **halved** in a year, to ~12%
- Opus 5 output costs ~**100x** DeepSeek V4 Flash's
- Reuters: may **rush a model** vs. Astra; IPO could slip

Counterpoints

- \$65B run-rate vs. OpenAI's ~\$40B (Reuters)
- Leads enterprise payments on Ramp: 43.5% vs 39.7%
- Claude Code is the #2 app on OpenRouter
- Q2 adjusted operating profit of ~\$559M

A call to slow AI from inside the labs briefly knocked chip stocks

The trigger, Sat Sep 12: Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei's essay "We Must Pace the Frontier" urged slowing capability gains by 1–2 years with outside evaluators. Altman, Musk and Hassabis backed it.

MON SEP 14

Chips sell off on the essay; Trump calls AI doom a "hoax"

Market: SOX **−4%** to **−6%**, SoftBank **−10%**; cyber stocks **+9–14%**

TUE SEP 15

OpenAI, Anthropic and Google confirm talks on a FINRA-style model-testing body; Sanders wants binding rules

Market: No clear market move; Cohere's CEO calls the plan "a cartel"

WED SEP 16

OpenAI discloses 6 new misalignment incidents, including a model that jailbroke itself

Market: Fed hike dominates: Nasdaq flat, Dow **−1.1%**

THU SEP 17

Nvidia's Huang: "we don't need new regulations"; Anthropic loosens bio safeguards for vetted labs

Market: SOX **+3.1%** rebound, driven mostly by lower yields and oil

FRI SEP 18

Reuters: Anthropic may rush a model vs. GPT-6 Astra; Altman to brief the UN Security Council

Market: Questions over Anthropic's safety pitch ahead of its IPO

- **Markets read "pacing" as a shorter AI capex cycle:** chips fell and cybersecurity rallied, but the S&P lost only ~0.5%
- **The shock faded in three days:** the White House rejected any slowdown, and Thursday's rebound came from rates
- **Anthropic's safety brand is now an IPO variable:** it called for pacing, then weighed a faster launch

Consumers stayed strong while factories and housing softened

Release (US)	Actual	Consensus	Prior	Read
Retail sales, Aug m/m	+1.2%	+0.9%	—	Stronger
Initial jobless claims	196k	—	206k	Stronger
Housing starts, Aug	1.275M	—	—	Declined
Industrial production, Aug	0.0%	+0.3%	+0.2%	Weaker
Capacity utilization	76.3%	76.4%	—	In line
Empire State mfg, Sep	+7.6	+14.0	—	Weaker
NAHB builders, Sep	32	34	35	Weaker

Backdrop: August CPI ran **3.4% y/y** (+0.4% m/m). Strong spending and a tight labor market with inflation this high gave the Fed room to hike, even though factories and housing are soft.

Next week: Treasury auctions, flash PMIs and the Xi visit

Day	Event	Why it matters
Mon 9/21	Chicago Fed NAI · China LPR	Japan holiday: thin Tokyo trading
Tue 9/22	\$78B 2-yr auction · Richmond Fed	First coupon auction since the hike
Wed 9/23	Flash PMIs (US/UK/EZ) · \$70B 5-yr	Growth check under tighter policy
Thu 9/24	Claims · new home sales · \$44B 7-yr	Housing with a 5% 10-year
Thu 9/24	SNB · Norges · Riksbank · Banxico	How far rate divergence spreads
Thu 9/24	Xi state visit · Costco earnings	Trade/Taiwan headlines; consumer
Fri 9/25	Durable goods · UMich final	Inflation expectations after the hike

New home sales consensus is 615k (607k prior). The August PCE date is not confirmed for this week.

SOURCES & NOTES

Sources

- [AP via KRMG: index closes](#)
- [TheStreet: Sept 18 recap](#)
- [StreetSignal Weekly](#)
- [Fed: Summary of Economic Projections](#)
- [Fed: Warsh press conference](#)
- [Economic Weekly: US data](#)
- [FXEmpire: dollar](#)
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- [stockanalysis.com: sector ETF closes](#)
- [S&P DJI: sector weights](#)
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- [Farside: bitcoin ETF flows](#)
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- [CNBC/Reuters: Anthropic IPO timing](#)
- [24/7 Wall St.: Anthropic compute](#)
- [Reuters: Ueda remarks](#)
- [SiliconANGLE: Astra for Law](#)
- [TechNode: Qwen3.8-Omni-Flash](#)
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- [TechCrunch: Crusoe](#)
- [TypeSafe AI: Jev launch post](#)
- [Investrade: week-ahead calendar](#)
- [Motley Fool: Anthropic vs. SpaceX IPO](#)
- [OfficeChai: OpenRouter spend](#)
- [Reuters: Anthropic may launch early](#)
- [Axios: AI safety week](#)